

THIN SIMPLICES VIA MODULAR ARITHMETIC

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Abstract

The local h^* -polynomial is a natural invariant of a lattice polytope appearing in Ehrhart theory and Hodge theory. In this work, we study the question posed in [GKZ94] concerning the classification of lattice simplices with vanishing local h^* -polynomial. Such simplices are called thin. We relate this question to linear codes and hyperplane arrangements over finite rings. This allows us to obtain a complete classification of the 4-dimensional thin simplices, extending the previously known results in dimensions up to 3.

1. INTRODUCTION

1.1. Local h^* -polynomial. Consider a lattice $M \subseteq \mathbb{R}^d$ and a d -dimensional lattice polytope Δ . It is known [Ehr62] that the number of points in an integral dilation $k\Delta$ is a polynomial in k . It is called the Ehrhart polynomial. This information can also be encoded in an invariant known as the h^* -polynomial. Namely, we have

$$1 + \sum_{k \geq 1} |k\Delta \cap M| t^k = \frac{h^*(\Delta, t)}{(1-t)^{d+1}}.$$

The main object of study in this paper is the *local h^* -polynomial*. This is a less-known variant of the h^* -polynomial that takes into account the point counting of the faces of Δ and the combinatorics of the face lattice of the polytope. In the case of Δ being a simplex, it can be defined as an alternating sum of h^* -polynomials of the faces of Δ

$$(1) \quad l^*(\Delta, t) := \sum_{F \subseteq \Delta} (-1)^{\dim \Delta - \dim F} h^*(F, t).$$

For a simplex it can also be computed as follows. Let Π_Δ° be the open parallelepiped spanned by the vertices of $\Delta \times \{1\} \subseteq \mathbb{R}^{d+1}$, then $l^*(\Delta, t)$ is the generating function of the number of points in Π_Δ° with a given last coordinate

$$l^*(\Delta, t) = \sum_{\lambda \in \Pi_\Delta^\circ \cap M \oplus \mathbb{Z}} t^{\lambda_{d+1}}.$$

For this reason the local h^* -polynomial of a simplex is also known as *box polynomial*.

This notion first appeared in the work of Betke and McMullen [BM85]. It was generalized to general polytopes by Stanley in [Sta92]. Later, it resurfaced independently in the work of Borisov and Mavlyutov [BM03]. They, along with Karu [Kar08], showed that the coefficients of the local h^* polynomial are non-negative. In [BB96] it was shown that these coefficients are the top weight Hodge-Deligne numbers of a nondegenerate affine hypersurface in a torus defined by the Newton polytope Δ .

More recently, the local h^* -polynomial has been studied more extensively. In the work [KS16] Katz and Stapledon described, among other things, how $l^*(\Delta, t)$ behaves under polyhedral subdivisions. The local h^* -polynomials of the simplices corresponding to the weighted projective spaces were studied in [Sol19] and those of the s -lecture hall simplices in [GS20]. In [Vil19] and [RRV22] $l^*(\Delta, t)$ of circuits appeared in the study of integrality of factorial ratios and hypergeometric motives, respectively. In [APPS22] the question of unimodality of the local h^* -polynomial was investigated. The work [BBC⁺23] discusses the local h^* -polynomial of simplices whose coordinates are in Hermitian normal form with one non-trivial row.

1.2. Thin simplices. One of the easy-sounding questions one may ask is when does $l^*(\Delta, t)$ vanish. This problem first appeared in the work of Gel'fand, Kapranov and Zelevinskii, see [GKZ94][11.4.B]. They coined the following definition.

Definition 1. We call a simplex Δ *thin* if $l^*(\Delta, t) = 0$.

Recently this question has been revived and extended to general polytopes by Borger, Kretschmer and Nill in [BKN23]. They were able to classify the three-dimensional thin lattice polytopes as well as to characterize the thin Gorenstein polytopes. Moreover, we refer to their work for a comprehensive review of local Ehrhart theory.

There is a construction that easily produces thin simplices. Let Δ_1 and Δ_2 be lattice polytopes of dimensions d_1 and d_2 . The *free join* of Δ_1 and Δ_2 is

$$\Delta_1 \circ_{\mathbb{Z}} \Delta_2 \simeq \text{conv} \left(\Delta_1 \times \{0^{d_2}\} \times \{0\}, \{0^{d_1}\} \times \Delta_2 \times \{1\} \right) \subseteq \mathbb{R}^{d_1+d_2+1}.$$

This construction is particularly nice from the Ehrhart-theoretic point of view since the (local) h^* -polynomial behaves multiplicatively under free joins, see [HT09] for

$$h^*(\Delta_1 \circ_{\mathbb{Z}} \Delta_2, t) = h^*(\Delta_1, t) \cdot h^*(\Delta_2, t)$$

and [NS13] for

$$l^*(\Delta_1 \circ_{\mathbb{Z}} \Delta_2, t) = l^*(\Delta_1, t) \cdot l^*(\Delta_2, t).$$

A notable example of a free join is a free join of a polytope Δ with a single point. In this case the resulting polytope $\text{Pyr}(\Delta)$ is called a *lattice pyramid* and we have $l^*(\text{Pyr}(\Delta), t) = 0$ and $h^*(\text{Pyr}(\Delta), t) = h^*(\Delta, t)$.

Clearly, if a free join is thin, then at least one of its factors must be thin. This leads to a natural question.

Question 1. Can we classify the thin simplices that are not free joins?

In dimension two the answer to this question was given in [GKZ94]. In this case the only such thin simplex is twice the standard simplex $2\Delta_2$. In dimension three the answer was provided in [BKN23]. They deduced that all three-dimensional thin simplices are lattice pyramids.

In order to answer this question in dimension four we make use of the point of view on lattice simplices presented in [BH13] which we review in Section 2. The crucial idea is that for each lattice simplex Δ we can construct an extended linear code C_{Δ} over $\mathbb{Z}_{N_{\Delta}}$ for some $N_{\Delta} \geq 1$. This correspondence is

in fact one-to-one up to the corresponding isomorphisms. A linear code C_Δ of rank m and length $d + 1$ can be generated by the rows of an $m \times (d + 1)$ matrix g_Δ . Thus, we can reduce the study of a simplex Δ to the study of a matrix g_Δ with entries from $\mathbb{Z}_{N_\Delta}$.

The property of Δ being thin translates to a simple property of C_Δ . The simplex Δ is thin if and only if the corresponding linear code C_Δ has no words of maximal weight, i.e. each element of C_Δ contains a zero.

One can go further and also use the language of hyperplane arrangements. The columns of the matrix g_Δ define a hyperplane arrangement $\mathcal{H}_\Delta$ inside $\mathbb{Z}_{N_\Delta}^m$. The thin simplices then correspond to the hyperplane arrangements $\mathcal{H}_\Delta$ that have vanishing complement.

1.3. Main result. The above point of view allows us to obtain a classification of the four-dimensional thin lattice simplices that are not lattice pyramids or free joins. It is summarized in the following theorem proved in Section 3.

Theorem 1. Let Δ be a four-dimensional thin simplex that is not a free join. Then Δ is either one of the 6 sporadic cases in the Table 1 below or it belongs to the following one-parameter family of width 1 given for even $N_\Delta \geq 2$ by

$$(2) \quad g_\Delta = \begin{pmatrix} N_\Delta/2 & 0 & N_\Delta/2 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & N_\Delta/2 & N_\Delta/2 & 1 & N_\Delta - 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

with

$$h^*(\Delta, t) = \left(\frac{3N_\Delta}{2} - 1 \right) t^2 + \frac{N_\Delta}{2} t + 1.$$

Case	g_Δ	N_Δ	$h^*(\Delta, t)$	width	spanning
1	$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$	2	$5t^2 + 10t + 1$	2	yes
2	$\begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 & 0 & 1 & 2 \end{pmatrix}$	3	$7t^2 + t + 1$	1	no
3	$\begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 & 2 \\ 2 & 2 & 1 & 3 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$	4	$5t^2 + 2t + 1$	1	no
4	$\begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 & 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 2 & 0 & 1 & 2 & 3 \end{pmatrix}$	4	$t^3 + 11t^2 + 3t + 1$	2	no
5	$\begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 & 2 \\ 2 & 2 & 0 & 2 & 2 \\ 0 & 2 & 3 & 3 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$	4	$9t^2 + 6t + 1$	2	yes
6	$\begin{pmatrix} 4 & 0 & 1 & 2 & 1 \\ 4 & 4 & 0 & 4 & 4 \end{pmatrix}$	8	$t^3 + 11t^2 + 3t + 1$	2	no

TABLE 1. Sporadic thin simplices for $d = 4$.

Case	Vertices
1	$(0, 0, 0, 0), (2, 0, 0, 0), (0, 2, 0, 0), (0, 0, 2, 0), (0, 0, 0, 2)$
2	$(-1, -1, 0, 1), (0, 0, 0, 0), (0, 1, 1, 1), (-1, 0, 1, -1), (1, -1, 1, 0)$
3	$(-1, 1, 0, 0), (0, 0, 0, 0), (-1, -1, -1, 1), (1, 1, -1, 1), (0, 0, 1, 1)$
4	$(-1, 1, -1, -1), (-1, -1, 0, -1), (0, 0, 1, 1), (1, 1, 0, -1), (0, 0, -1, 1)$
5	$(-1, 0, 1, -1), (0, 2, -1, -1), (-1, 0, -1, 1), (1, 0, -1, 1), (0, 0, 1, 1)$
6	$(0, 0, 0, -1), (0, -1, -1, -1), (1, -1, 1, 1), (-1, 0, 0, 1), (1, 1, -1, 1)$
family	$(-1, 0, 0, 0), (1, -1, -3, 2), (1, 0, 0, 0), (0, N/2, -N/2 + 1, 0), (0, 0, 1, 0)$

TABLE 2. Vertices of the thin simplices from Theorem 1.

We see that, contrary to the dimensions ≤ 3 , in dimension 4 there are infinitely many thin simplices that are not free joins.

1.4. Experiments and questions. By using linear codes instead of simplices, it becomes somewhat easier to produce examples of thin simplices. By considering generating matrices of extended linear codes over $\mathbb{Z}_{N_\Delta}$ for N_Δ small and with only a few rows, one can relatively quickly obtain a small database of thin simplices. The corresponding SageMath [The22] code is available on GitHub¹. Using the criterion from Remark 3 we can quickly establish which simplices are definitely not free joins. In Table 3 the found data is presented. This is by far not a classification.

d	#	spanning	width 1	width 2	empty	non-trivially thin
5	69	0	69	0	5	67
6	704	4	655	49	35	541
7	1071	0	1071	0	130	1053

TABLE 3. Thin simplices that are not free joins found experimentally

It is interesting to look at different subclasses of thin simplices, as suggested in [BKN23]. An important class of lattice polytopes consists of *spanning* lattice polytopes, i.e. the polytopes whose integral points affinely span the ambient lattice. Note the scarcity of spanning thin simplices in the above table. In dimension 4 we also have only 2 spanning thin simplices. Furthermore, it is somewhat surprising that we were not able to find any spanning thin simplices in dimensions 5 and 7. This naturally leads to the following questions.

Question 2. Are there finitely many spanning thin simplices that are not free joins in each dimension? Are there any in the odd-dimensional case?

We discuss spanning thin simplices more in Subsection 2.5.

Another important property of a lattice polytope Δ is its *lattice width*, that is the minimal distance between two parallel hyperplanes in $\mathbb{R}^d$ such that Δ lies between them. As discussed in [BKN23], it seems that thin lattice polytopes tend to have small width. To compute the lattice width we first make use of Proposition 4 from Subsection 2.6 to single out width 1 simplices and then we use Polymake [AGH⁺17] to compute the width of

¹<https://github.com/VadymKurylenko/Thin-Simplices>

the remaining examples. One can see that the amount of thin simplices of width ≥ 2 is rather small and in odd dimensions we were not able to find any. We would like to state a few conjectures in the strongest form possible.

Conjecture 1. In each even dimension there are only finitely many thin simplices of lattice width ≥ 2 .

Conjecture 2. In odd dimensions all thin simplices have width 1.

One can also ask whether these conjectures hold for thin polytopes, that are not simplices. As was shown in [BKN23], all three-dimensional thin polytopes have width 1.

In [BKN23] a question was asked whether there are thin *empty* simplices with non-trivial quotient group in dimensions ≥ 5 . We answer this question positively. All the empty simplices considered in the table above have a non-trivial quotient group. Moreover, all of them have width 1. Here is an example.

Example 1. The 6-dimensional simplex, whose vertices are the columns of

$$\begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 3 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 & -1 & -1 & 2 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & -3 & -6 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 2 & -6 & -2 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 10 & -2 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & -2 & 2 \end{pmatrix},$$

is thin and empty with $h^*(\Delta, t) = 3t^4 + 12t^3 + 16t^2 + 1$. Its quotient group is $\mathbb{Z}_2 \times \mathbb{Z}_2 \times \mathbb{Z}_8$. The corresponding linear code over $\mathbb{Z}_8$ can be generated by

$$\begin{pmatrix} 0 & 3 & 3 & 4 & 4 & 5 & 5 \\ 4 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 4 & 4 & 4 \\ 0 & 0 & 4 & 4 & 4 & 0 & 4 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Finally, a thin polytope Δ is called *trivially thin* if $\deg h^*(\Delta, t) \leq d/2$. We see that most of the found thin simplices that are not free joins are non-trivially thin.

1.5. Structure of the paper. In Section 2 we review the basics of Ehrhart theory of simplices and explain the relationship between simplices, linear codes, and hyperplane arrangements. Using this connection, we derive certain necessary conditions for a simplex to be thin. We continue the section by focusing on the case of spanning thin simplices. In the end of the section we discuss how to characterize lattice simplices of width 1 in terms of the corresponding linear code. Based on the above results, in Section 3 we classify the four-dimensional thin simplices.

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2. LATTICE SIMPLICES AND MODULAR ARITHMETIC

2.1. Our Setup. For a general lattice polytope Δ the coefficients of the h^* -polynomial do not have a known simple combinatorial interpretation. However, if Δ is a simplex, then one can consider the following. Let us denote the vertices of the simplex by $v_0, \dots, v_d$ and let $(v_i, 1)$ be the lift of v_i to $M \oplus \mathbb{Z}$. Consider the set of points

$$\Pi_\Delta = \left\{ \sum_{i=0}^d a_i(v_i, 1), \quad 0 \leq a_i < 1 \right\}.$$

It is called half-open parallelepiped associated to Δ . The h^* -polynomial of Δ can be written in a nice way as a sum over integral points inside Π_Δ .

$$h^*(\Delta, t) = \sum_{\lambda \in \Pi_\Delta \cap M \oplus \mathbb{Z}} t^{\lambda_{d+1}}.$$

In other words, the k th coefficient of the polynomial $h^*(\Delta, t)$ is the number of integral points in the half-open parallelepiped Π_Δ at height k .

Betke and McMullen [BM85] suggested to look at a slight modification of this. Consider the open parallelepiped

$$\Pi_\Delta^\circ = \left\{ \sum_{i=0}^d a_i(v_i, 1), \quad 0 < a_i < 1 \right\}$$

and the polynomial

$$l^*(\Delta, t) = \sum_{\lambda \in \Pi_\Delta^\circ \cap M \oplus \mathbb{Z}} t^{\lambda_{d+1}}.$$

It is called local h^* -polynomial. Since it enumerates the number of points inside a parallelepiped, that is, a box, it is also known as *box polynomial*. Let us discuss some of its properties. From this definition it is evident that the coefficients of $l^*(\Delta, t)$ are non-negative numbers. In particular, the linear coefficient is the number of lattice points in the interior of the simplex

$$l_1^*(\Delta) = |\Delta^\circ \cap M|.$$

Therefore, if Δ is thin, then it must have no interior lattice points, i.e. it is hollow.

Since on Π_Δ° there is an involution given by

$$\sum a_i(v_i, 1) \rightarrow \sum (1 - a_i)(v_i, 1),$$

the polynomial $l^*(\Delta, t)$ is palindromic.

Note that these properties still hold if Δ is not simplex.

2.2. Linear codes. We are going to relate lattice simplices to linear codes, so here are the necessary definitions and facts from coding theory. Let $\mathbb{Z}_N$ be the ring of integers modulo N . **In this paper we always identify the elements of $\mathbb{Z}_N$ with their representatives $0, 1, \dots, N-1$.** In particular, this allows us to speak about gcd of the elements of $\mathbb{Z}_N$, by which we mean the usual integer gcd of the corresponding representatives.

Definition 2. A *linear code* of length n over $\mathbb{Z}_N$ is a submodule C of the free module $\mathbb{Z}_N^n$.

A standard way to produce a linear code is to take an $m \times n$ matrix g over $\mathbb{Z}_N$ and consider the submodule of $\mathbb{Z}_N^n$ generated by the rows of g . The elements of a linear code are called *words*. For a word $c \in C$ its *weight* is the number of non-zero entries

$$w(c) := |\{i : c_i \neq 0\}|.$$

The generating function of weights is called *weight enumerator*

$$W_C(X) = \sum_{c \in C} X^{w(c)}.$$

We call two linear codes C_1 and C_2 of length n *isomorphic* if after a possible permutation of indices the sets of words coincide, that is, there exists a permutation $\sigma \in S_n$ such that

$$\{c : c \in C_1\} = \{\sigma(c) : c \in C_2\}.$$

Clearly, isomorphic linear codes have the same weight enumerator. Moreover, if a linear code is defined by a generating matrix, then any permutation of its rows and columns defines an isomorphic linear code.

Definition 3. We call a linear code C *extended* if for every word $c \in C$ we have $\sum c_i = 0 \pmod{N}$.

In this paper we use only extended linear codes. For an extended linear code C we can define the *height* of a word $c \in C$ to be

$$\text{ht}(c) := \frac{1}{N} \sum_{i=1}^n c_i.$$

2.3. From simplices to linear codes. Let $\Delta \subseteq M \simeq \mathbb{Z}^d$ be a d -dimensional lattice simplex with vertex set $v_0, \dots, v_d$. Following [BH13] one can associate the following additive group to a simplex:

$$\Lambda_\Delta := \left\{ (x_0, \dots, x_d) \in (\mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z})^{d+1} : \sum_{i=0}^d \{x_i\}(v_i, 1) \in M \oplus \mathbb{Z} \right\},$$

where $\{\cdot\} : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow [0, 1)$ is the fractional part function.

We can consider the group Λ_Δ as a linear code. Let N_Δ be the least common multiple of the denominators of x_i 's of Λ_Δ . Since the order of Λ_Δ is the normalized volume of the simplex, N_Δ is a divisor of $\text{vol}_\mathbb{Z}(\Delta)$. Given an element $(x_0, \dots, x_d)$, we take the representative $(\{x_0\}, \dots, \{x_d\})$ and multiply it by N_Δ . In this way we can promote each element of Λ_Δ to a word of an extended code over $\mathbb{Z}_{N_\Delta}$. Let us denote this linear code by C_Δ

$$C_\Delta := \left\{ c = (c_0, \dots, c_d) \in (\mathbb{Z}_{N_\Delta})^{d+1} : \sum c_i(v_i, 1) = 0 \pmod{N_\Delta} \right\}.$$

Since N_Δ was chosen to be minimal, the greatest common divisor of all the entries of all the words with N_Δ is 1.

Recall that two lattice simplices Δ_1 and Δ_2 are *isomorphic* if there is an affine unimodular transformation of the ambient lattice M mapping Δ_1 to Δ_2 . The following theorem is crucial since it allows us to talk interchangeably about simplices and linear codes.

Theorem 2 ([BH13], Theorem 2.3.). Up to the corresponding isomorphisms there is a one-to-one correspondence between d -dimensional lattice simplices and extended linear codes C of length $d + 1$ over $\mathbb{Z}_N$ for $N \geq 1$ such that the greatest common divisor of all the entries of all the words in C and N is 1.

So far, we only described how from a given simplex one constructs the corresponding linear code. Let us also describe the inverse construction. Let C be an extended code over $\mathbb{Z}_N$ of length $d + 1$. Consider the natural projection map $\pi : \mathbb{Z}^{d+1} \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}_N^{d+1}$. The preimage $M := \pi^{-1}(C)$ is a sublattice of $\mathbb{Z}^{d+1}$. Let $e_0, \dots, e_d$ be the standard basis of $\mathbb{Z}^{d+1}$. Define the simplex

$$\Delta_C = \text{conv}(Ne_0, \dots, Ne_d)$$

with respect to the affine lattice $\text{aff}(Ne_0, \dots, Ne_d) \cap M$. This gives us a map $C \rightarrow \Delta_C$.

Example 2. Consider twice the standard two-dimensional simplex $\Delta = 2\Delta_2$. As was already mentioned in Introduction, this is the only interesting thin simplex in dimension two. The coordinates of its vertices are $(0, 0)$, $(2, 0)$, $(0, 2)$. The corresponding group Λ_Δ has $\text{vol}_{\mathbb{Z}}(\Delta) = 4$ elements, namely

$$\left\{ (0, 0, 0), \left(\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{2}, 0\right), \left(\frac{1}{2}, 0, \frac{1}{2}\right), \left(0, \frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{2}\right) \right\}.$$

We see that $N_\Delta = 2$ and the corresponding linear code C_Δ is a linear code over $\mathbb{Z}_2$ with 4 words

$$\{(0, 0, 0), (1, 1, 0), (1, 0, 1), (0, 1, 1)\}.$$

This linear code can be generated by the following matrix

$$g_\Delta = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Let us now describe how to go back to the simplex from this linear code. The lattice M is generated by $f_0 = (1, 1, 0)$, $f_1 = (0, 1, 1)$ and $f_2 = (1, 0, 1)$. The affine lattice $\text{aff}(2e_0, 2e_1, 2e_2)$ is the two-dimensional affine lattice given by $\{x \in \mathbb{Z}^3 : x_0 + x_1 + x_2 = 2\}$. Thus, $\text{aff}(2e_0, 2e_1, 2e_2) \cap M$ is the affine sublattice of M given by

$$\{af_0 + bf_1 + cf_2 : (a, b, c) \in \mathbb{Z}^3, a + b + c = 1\} \subseteq M.$$

The vertices of the simplex are given by $(2, 0, 0)$, $(0, 2, 0)$, $(0, 0, 2)$ in M , and thus in $\text{aff}(2e_0, 2e_1, 2e_2) \cap M$ they are given by $(1, -1, 1)$, $(1, 1, -1)$, $(-1, 1, 1)$. After rotating everything with the matrix $((1, 1, 0), (0, 1, 1), (1, 1, 1))$ we can project to the first two coordinates and obtain the simplex $2\Delta_2$ in its usual form.

Note that the height of a word $c \in C_\Delta$ corresponds to the height of the vector $\sum_{i=0}^d \frac{c_i}{N_\Delta} (v_i, 1)$ in the half-open parallelepiped of Δ . Therefore, we can calculate the h^* -polynomial of a simplex Δ via the corresponding linear code

$$h^*(\Delta, t) = \sum_{c \in C_\Delta} t^{\text{ht}(c)}.$$

Moreover, the words that have no zeros correspond exactly to the points of Π_Δ° , giving us an expression for the local h^* -polynomial

$$l^*(\Delta, t) = \sum_{\substack{c \in C_\Delta \\ w(c)=d+1}} t^{\text{ht}(c)}.$$

From this we see that the thinness of the simplex Δ translates into a nice property of the corresponding linear code. The sum defining $l^*(\Delta, t)$ is empty if there are no words of weight $d + 1$ in C_Δ . This motivates the following definition.

Definition 4. An extended linear code C is called *thin* if it contains no words of maximal weight.

Corollary 1. A lattice simplex Δ is thin if and only if the corresponding linear code C_Δ is thin.

Note, that the linear code considered in the Example 2 above is thin.

It is easy to see [BH13] that the lattice simplex Δ is a lattice pyramid if and only if the corresponding linear code is *degenerate*. This means that there exists an index $i \in \{0, \dots, d\}$ such that every word $c \in C_\Delta$ has $c_i = 0$. In other words, all the generating matrices of C_Δ have a column of zeros.

We also have to translate the construction of free joins to the language of linear codes. Consider first the following definition.

Definition 5. Suppose C_1 and C_2 are linear codes over $\mathbb{Z}_{N_1}$ and $\mathbb{Z}_{N_2}$ correspondingly. A *direct sum* of C_1 and C_2 is the linear code $C_1 \oplus C_2$ over $\mathbb{Z}_{\text{lcm}(N_1, N_2)}$ whose words are given by

$$\left\{ \frac{\text{lcm}(N_1, N_2)}{N_1} \cdot c_1 \mid \frac{\text{lcm}(N_1, N_2)}{N_2} \cdot c_2 : c_1 \in C_1, c_2 \in C_2 \right\},$$

where $\mid$ is the usual concatenation. This construction corresponds exactly to the free joins on the simplices side.

Lemma 1. A simplex Δ is a free join of the simplices Δ_1 and Δ_2 if and only if the corresponding linear code C_Δ is a direct sum of the linear codes C_{Δ_1} and C_{Δ_2} .

Proof. It is clear from the construction that if a simplex is a free join, then the corresponding linear code is a direct sum. Now suppose we have a linear code C over $\mathbb{Z}_N$ which is a direct sum $C = C_1 \oplus C_2$. The corresponding simplices are $\Delta_C = \Delta_{C_1 \oplus C_2}$. We know that the simplex $\Delta_1 \circ_{\mathbb{Z}} \Delta_2$ is isomorphic to $\Delta_{C_1 \oplus C_2}$. By the fact that the correspondence in Theorem 2 is one-to-one we can conclude that $\Delta_C \simeq \Delta_1 \circ_{\mathbb{Z}} \Delta_2$. $\square$

Remark 3. If a linear code C is a direct sum $C_1 \oplus C_2$, then the weight enumerator of C factorizes

$$W_C(X) = W_{C_1}(X) \cdot W_{C_2}(X).$$

This gives a useful necessary condition for deciding if the simplex C_Δ is a free join. Namely, if both the polynomials $W_C(X)$ and $h^*(\Delta_C)$ factorize into polynomials with non-negative coefficients, then Δ_C might be a free join,

but a priori it is not guaranteed to be one. For example, consider the code C of length 7 over $\mathbb{Z}_4$ generated by

$$\begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 & 2 & 2 & 2 & 2 & 3 \\ 2 & 3 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 2 & 1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

We have

$$W_C(X) = (X^2 + 1)(3X^4 + 1), \quad h^*(\Delta_C, t) = (t + 1)(3t + 1).$$

This code is non-degenerate, so if it is a direct sum it must have two non-degenerate factors. In particular, one of the factors must correspond to a simplex that is not a lattice pyramid and has $h^*(\Delta, t) = t + 1$. Using the classification of degree 1 lattice polytopes in [BN07] we can deduce that this factor must correspond to the 1-dimensional simplex $[0, 2]$. Therefore, the second factor must correspond to a 5-dimensional simplex with $h^*(\Delta, t) = 3t + 1$ that is not a lattice pyramid. Using the same classification, one can deduce that this is not possible.

2.4. From simplices to hyperplane arrangements. Let g be an $m \times n$ generating matrix of a linear code C over $\mathbb{Z}_N$. Let g_i be the i th column of g . Define

$$H_i = \{x \in \mathbb{Z}_N^m \mid g_i \cdot x = 0 \pmod{N}\}.$$

We call this set the *hyperplane* defined by g_i . This way from a linear code we get a hyperplane arrangement over $\mathbb{Z}_N$

$$\mathcal{H}_C = \{H_0, \dots, H_d\}.$$

If the linear code is the code C_Δ coming from a lattice simplex, let us denote this hyperplane arrangement as $\mathcal{H}_\Delta$. The following proposition is going to be the central tool for classifying the four-dimensional thin simplices.

Corollary 2. A simplex Δ is thin if and only if the complement of $\mathcal{H}_\Delta$ is empty, i.e. $\mathbb{Z}_N^m = H_0 \cup H_1 \cup \dots \cup H_d$.

Proof. Suppose g_Δ is a generating matrix of C_Δ and it has m rows. Then the words of C_Δ can be obtained by multiplying g_Δ from the left by all the possible $a = (a_1, a_2, \dots, a_m) \in \mathbb{Z}_N^m$. Now, clearly, if every a belongs to $\mathcal{H}_\Delta$, then every word has a zero at some place. Furthermore, if a word has a zero at the i th place, it means that the corresponding points a belong to the hyperplane H_i . Thus, if every word has a zero somewhere, then all the points a belong to some hyperplane. $\square$

For a hyperplane H_i defined by the column g_i of the $m \times (d + 1)$ generating matrix g_Δ define

$$(3) \quad \text{gcd}_i := \text{gcd}(g_{1i}, \dots, g_{mi}, N).$$

Then the hyperplane H_i contains $\text{gcd}_i \cdot N^{m-1}$ points (see e.g. [Smi61]).

We give a necessary condition for the code C to be thin.

Proposition 1. Let C be a linear code of length $d + 1$ over $\mathbb{Z}_N$ and g be its generating matrix. If the linear code C is thin, then

$$\sum_{i=0}^d \text{gcd}_i > N.$$

Proof. Suppose g has m rows. Let $\{H_0, \dots, H_d\}$ be the corresponding hyperplane arrangement. All the hyperplanes contain at most $\sum_{i=0}^d \gcd_i \cdot N^{m-1}$ points. Since the point 0^m belongs to all of them, we arrive at the strict inequality

$$\sum_{i=0}^d \gcd_i \cdot N^{m-1} > N^m.$$

□

In principle, one can continue with the inclusion-exclusion procedure to account for the intersections of subsets of the hyperplanes. But the expressions for the number of points of these intersections become more difficult and it does not seem practical to proceed this way.

Corollary 3. If C is thin and every $\gcd_i = 1$ (in particular, if N is prime), then $d \geq N$.

Corollary 4. Let p be the smallest prime in the factorization of N . If C is thin, then $d \geq p$.

Proof. Suppose first that $N = p^k$ for some $k \geq 1$. Then at worst we have d columns with $\gcd_i = p^{k-1}$, and the remaining column must have $\gcd_i = 1$ since otherwise the whole generating matrix g has a common factor. Thus $d p^{k-1} + 1 > p^k$, from which it follows that $p \leq d$.

Now suppose that $p_1 < p_2$ are the two smallest distinct primes in the factorization of N . Then at worst there are d columns with $\gcd_i = N/p_1$ and one column with $\gcd_i = N/p_2$. Thus,

$$d > p_1 - \frac{p_1}{p_2}.$$

Since $0 < p_1/p_2 < 1$, we have $d \geq p_1$. □

2.5. Spanning thin simplices. A lattice polytope Δ is called *spanning* if every point in $M \oplus \mathbb{Z}$ is a integer linear combination of the lattice points in $\Delta \times \{1\}$. Spanning lattice simplices have a nice characterization in terms of linear codes.

Proposition 2. A lattice simplex Δ is spanning if and only if the corresponding linear code C_Δ can be generated by a matrix g whose rows have height one.

Proof. The "only if" direction is straightforward. Since Δ is spanning, every word in C_Δ is a combination of words that correspond to the lattice points of the simplex, this gives a generating matrix with height one rows.

For the "if" direction consider the half-open parallelepiped. Since C_Δ is generated by the words of height one, it means that any point inside Π_Δ is a linear combination with integral coefficients of the points at height one. Since we can cover $M \oplus \mathbb{Z}$ by translating Π_Δ by multiples of $(v_i, 1)$ it follows that any lattice point is expressible through the points of $\Delta \times \{1\}$, i.e. Δ is spanning. □

Remark 4. Note that if Δ is spanning we might need a lot of rows to have a generating matrix with all rows having height 1. There is a universal bound

on this number, namely one needs at most $(d+1)2^{(d+1)}$ rows, see [?] and [?].

For example, the simplex corresponding to the linear code generated by

$$\begin{pmatrix} 3 & 3 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 3 & 0 & 3 & 1 & 5 \end{pmatrix}$$

over $\mathbb{Z}_6$ is spanning since this code can also be generated by

$$\begin{pmatrix} 3 & 3 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 3 & 0 & 3 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 5 \end{pmatrix}.$$

However, this linear code cannot be generated by a matrix with two rows with height 1.

Nevertheless, when N is prime and a linear code C of dimension m corresponds to a spanning simplex, then this code can be generated by a matrix with exactly m rows with height 1.

As we mentioned in the introduction we expect that spanning thin simplices are relatively rare. It seems that it is particularly so for the simplices with prime N_Δ . In particular, computations in low dimensions ($d \leq 8$) suggest the following conjecture.

Conjecture 3. For prime $N \geq 3$ there are no non-degenerate thin codes corresponding to spanning simplices.

The following proposition shows that this conjecture is true for the linear codes of dimension 2. Moreover, it gives some weak bounds for the codes of higher dimension.

Theorem 5. Suppose N is prime. Let Δ be a spanning thin simplex and C be the corresponding linear code of dimension $m \geq 2$ over $\mathbb{Z}_N$. Then $N \leq N_m$ for N_m given by

$$2, 17, 83, 379, 1499, 5987$$

for $2 \leq m \leq 7$ respectively.

Proof. Since N is prime, every column has $\gcd_i = 1$. Since the code can be generated by a matrix g with m rows of height 1, the sum of all the entries of the generating matrix is mN . By Corollary 3 the arrangement $\mathcal{H}_\Delta$ might have empty complement only if there are at least $N+1$ different hyperplanes. We want to estimate the sum of the entries of the normals that define these hyperplanes, that is, the sum of the entries of g . We will use this estimate to show that for a fixed m starting from some N the sum of the entries of g with $N+1$ different columns can only be larger than mN .

Let H be a hyperplane in $\mathbb{Z}_N^m$ defined by a normal h . Let us call h minimal and denote it $h_{\min}$ if the sum of its entries is the smallest possible among all the normals defining the same hyperplane. Note, that minimal h can be not unique. For example, consider $N = 7$, $m = 2$ and the hyperplane defined by the normal $h = (2, 3)$. This h is not minimal and the minimal one is given by $h_{\min} = (3, 1) = 5 \cdot (2, 3)$. If we consider the hyperplane defined by $(6, 1)$, then all its normals are minimal.

Let us introduce a function that sends a hyperplane to the sum of the entries of its minimal normal

$$n : H \rightarrow \sum_{i=1}^m (h_{\min})_i.$$

This function defines a total ordering on the set of hyperplanes in $\mathbb{Z}_N^m$ by $H \leq \tilde{H}$ if and only if $n(H) \leq n(\tilde{H})$. Let us index the hyperplanes in $\mathbb{Z}_N^m$ by $\mathbb{N}$ in a way compatible with the order above. For example, the hyperplane defined by $h = (1, 0)$ is H_1 , the one defined by $(0, 1)$ is H_2 , the one defined by $(1, 1)$ is H_3 , etc.. We are interested in evaluating the sum

$$S(m, N) = \sum_{i=1}^{N+1} n(H_i).$$

Note that this sum does not depend on the chosen indexing.

Let us denote by $c_i(m, N)$ the number of the hyperplanes H in $\mathbb{Z}_N^m$ with $n(H) = i$. Define

$$k_{m,N} := \min \left\{ k \in \mathbb{N} : \sum_{i=1}^{k+1} c_i(m, N) > N + 1 \right\}.$$

Now we can write

$$S(m, N) = \sum_{i=1}^{k_{m,N}} i c_i(m, N) + \left(N + 1 - \sum_{i=1}^{k_{m,N}} c_i(m, N) \right) (k_{m,N} + 1).$$

We can also consider the same situation in $\mathbb{Z}^m$. We can again put a total order on the set of hyperplanes and we can define $c_i(m)$ to be the number of hyperplanes in $\mathbb{Z}^m$ with $n(H) = i$, which can be computed as

$$c_i(m) = \left| \left\{ (x_1, \dots, x_m) \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}^m : \sum_{j=1}^m x_j = i \text{ and } \gcd(x_1, \dots, x_m) = 1 \right\} \right|.$$

This number is also known as the number of new colors that can be mixed with i units of m given colors, see [OEI24] for $m = 3$. For $m = 2$ it is exactly the value of the Euler's totient function $c_i(2) = \phi(i)$. The generating function of $c_i(m)$ can be given by

$$\sum_{i \geq 0} c_i(m) t^i = \sum_{k \geq 1} \frac{\mu(k)}{(1 - t^k)^m}.$$

In the same manner we define

$$k_{m,N}^{\mathbb{Z}} = \min \left\{ k \in \mathbb{N} : \sum_{i=1}^{k+1} c_i(m) > N + 1 \right\}$$

and

$$S^{\mathbb{Z}}(m, N) := \sum_{i=1}^{k_{m,N}^{\mathbb{Z}}} i c_i(m) + \left(N + 1 - \sum_{i=1}^{k_{m,N}^{\mathbb{Z}}} c_i(m) \right) (k_{m,N}^{\mathbb{Z}} + 1).$$

Note that this sum also makes sense for a non-prime N .

Lemma 2. For a prime N we have $S(m, N) \geq S^{\mathbb{Z}}(m, N)$.

Proof. First of all, notice that $c_i(m) \geq c_i(m, N)$. This implies that for a given N the value of $k_{m,N}^{\mathbb{Z}}$ cannot be larger than $k_{m,N}$. Suppose $k_{m,N}^{\mathbb{Z}} = k_{m,N} - x$ for some $x \geq 0$. Consider

$$\begin{aligned} S(m, N) - S^{\mathbb{Z}}(m, N) &= \sum_{i=1}^{k_{m,N}-x} (i - (k_{m,N} + 1)) (c_i(m, N) - c_i(m)) - \\ &- \sum_{i=k_{m,N}-x+1}^{k_{m,N}} c_i(m, N) (k_{m,N} + 1 - i) + x \left((N + 1) - \sum_{i=1}^{k_{m,N}-x} c_i(m) \right). \end{aligned}$$

In the second sum $k_{m,N} + 1 - i$ is always positive and $k_{m,N} + 1 - i \leq x$, therefore if we substitute $k_{m,N} + 1 - i$ with x and use $c_i(m) \geq c_i(m, N)$ we get

$$\begin{aligned} S(m, N) - S^{\mathbb{Z}}(m, N) &\geq \\ &\sum_{i=1}^{k_{m,N}-x} (i - (k_{m,N} + 1)) (c_i(m, N) - c_i(m)) + x \left((N + 1) - \sum_{i=1}^{k_{m,N}} c_i(m) \right). \end{aligned}$$

All the summands above are non-negative, thus $S(m, N) \geq S^{\mathbb{Z}}(m, N)$. $\square$

Now we want to show that for each m there exists $N_m^{\mathbb{Z}}$ such that for $N > N_m^{\mathbb{Z}}$ we have $S^{\mathbb{Z}}(m, N) > mN$. This would imply that for a given m there cannot be any spanning thin simplices with $N > N_m^{\mathbb{Z}}$.

Lemma 3. The function $S^{\mathbb{Z}}(m, N)$ grows with N , namely

$$S^{\mathbb{Z}}(m, N + 1) - S^{\mathbb{Z}}(m, N) = k_{m,N}^{\mathbb{Z}} + 1.$$

Moreover, this growth is non-decreasing.

Proof. Note that the consecutive values of $k_{m,N}^{\mathbb{Z}}$ can either be the same or differ by one, namely

$$k_{m,N+1}^{\mathbb{Z}} = k_{m,N}^{\mathbb{Z}} + \varepsilon_{m,N}$$

with $\varepsilon_{m,N} \in \{0, 1\}$. Consider

$$S^{\mathbb{Z}}(m, N + 1) - S^{\mathbb{Z}}(m, N) = k_{m,N}^{\mathbb{Z}} + 1 + \varepsilon_{m,N} \left(N + 2 - \sum_{i=1}^{k_{m,N}^{\mathbb{Z}} + \varepsilon_{m,N}} c_i(m) \right).$$

When $\varepsilon_{m,N} = 0$ the last summand does not appear. When $\varepsilon_{m,N} = 1$ it means that we actually have exactly $\sum_{i=1}^{k_{m,N}^{\mathbb{Z}} + 1} c_i(m) = N + 2$ and overall it gives

$$S^{\mathbb{Z}}(m, N + 1) - S^{\mathbb{Z}}(m, N) = k_{m,N}^{\mathbb{Z}} + 1$$

This is always positive, so $S^{\mathbb{Z}}(m, N)$ always grows with increasing N . Moreover, this growth is non-decreasing since

$$\left(S^{\mathbb{Z}}(m, N + 2) - S^{\mathbb{Z}}(m, N + 1) \right) - \left(S^{\mathbb{Z}}(m, N + 1) - S^{\mathbb{Z}}(m, N) \right)$$

can only take values 0 and 1. $\square$

This lemma shows that there exists $N_m^{\mathbb{Z}}$ such that for every $N > N_m^{\mathbb{Z}}$ the difference $(S^{\mathbb{Z}}(m, N+1) - S^{\mathbb{Z}}(m, N)) \geq m+1$. We can find $N_m^{\mathbb{Z}}$ computationally for small values of m .

m	2	3	4	5	6	7
$N_m^{\mathbb{Z}}$	2	18	86	380	1502	5992

By considering for each $N_m^{\mathbb{Z}}$ the closest prime from below we get the values of N_m for $S(m, N)$ from the statement of the theorem. $\square$

2.6. Lattice width. In this subsection we show that lattice simplices of width 1 have a useful description in terms of the corresponding linear codes.

Let $\langle -, - \rangle$ denote the standard scalar product in $\mathbb{R}^d$. The lattice width of a lattice polytope is defined as the minimum of

$$\max_{x \in \Delta} \langle u, x \rangle - \min_{x \in \Delta} \langle u, x \rangle$$

over all non-zero integer linear forms u .

The lattice polytopes of width 1 are also known as *Cayley polytopes*. Another equivalent definition is as follows. A d -dimensional lattice polytope Δ is Cayley of length m , if there exists a lattice projection $\mathbb{Z}^d \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}^{m-1}$ that maps Δ onto the standard simplex Δ_{m-1} .

A few similar notions were considered by Arnau Padrol in his PhD thesis [Pad13]. In the first one, instead of considering the standard simplex as the image of projection, one can relax this condition and project to any simplex. One calls a point configuration *affine Cayley* of length m if there exists a projection $\mathbb{R}^d \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^{m-1}$ that maps Δ onto the vertex set of an $(m-1)$ -dimensional simplex.

For the second notion consider the following. Let V be a vector configuration. It is called *affine Cayley** of length m if there exists a partition

$$V = V_1 \sqcup V_2 \sqcup \dots \sqcup V_m,$$

such that $\sum_{v \in V_i} v = 0$ for all $i = 1, \dots, m$.

At first, the above two definitions seem not to be related. To connect the two one has to introduce the concept of Gale duality. Suppose A is a d -dimensional point configuration consisting of n vectors. Let M be the $(d+1) \times n$ matrix whose columns are the coordinates of the points from A with 1 appended, that is the homogeneous coordinates of the points of A . Let $b_1, \dots, b_{n-d-1}$ be a basis of the kernel of M . Set M^* to be the matrix whose rows are exactly the vectors b_i . We define the vector configuration consisting of the column vectors of M^* to be a Gale dual A^* of A . Now we can state the following.

Proposition 3 (Proposition 7.22 in [Pad13]). A point configuration is affine Cayley if and only if its Gale dual is affine Cayley*.

We are interested in the situations when the point configuration A is the configuration of the lattice points of a simplex Δ . In this case we can read the matrix M^* from the linear code C_Δ . Suppose Δ has $d+1+m$ lattice

points. Then there are m words $c_1, \dots, c_m$ of height 1 in C_Δ . Each such word gives a row in the matrix $M^\star$ that takes the form

$$M^\star = \begin{pmatrix} -N_\Delta & 0 & \dots & 0 & c_{10} & c_{11} & \dots & c_{1d} \\ 0 & -N_\Delta & \dots & 0 & c_{20} & c_{21} & \dots & c_{2d} \\ \vdots & \vdots & \vdots & \vdots & \vdots & \vdots & \vdots & \vdots \\ 0 & 0 & \dots & -N_\Delta & c_{m0} & c_{m1} & \dots & c_{md} \end{pmatrix}.$$

The last $d + 1$ columns correspond to the vertices of the simplex and the first m columns correspond to the m remaining lattice points. Clearly, the rows are linearly independent, so the columns of this matrix indeed give us a Gale dual.

For linear codes there exists a natural analog of affine Cayley^{*} configurations.

Definition 6. We say that an extended linear code of length $d + 1$ over $\mathbb{Z}_N$ *splits* into m parts if there is a set partition $I_1, \dots, I_m$ of $\{0, 1, \dots, d\}$ such that for any $j = 1, \dots, m$ and any word c we have $\sum_{i \in I_j} c_i = 0 \pmod{N}$.

This definition, in particular, implies that if the code C splits, then for each height 1 word c there exists k , such that $c_i = 0$ for all $i \in \{0, \dots, d\} \setminus I_k$. This in turn implies that the above matrix $M^\star$ has a nice block-diagonal structure after permuting the columns. Therefore, if C splits, then the corresponding simplex is affine Cayley^{*}. Moreover, the condition of splitting is stronger than just being affine Cayley^{*} and it implies that the simplex must be Cayley, which we show in the next proposition.

Proposition 4. A lattice simplex Δ is Cayley of length m if and only if the corresponding linear code splits into m parts.

Proof. We will treat the case $m = 2$. One can easily generalize it to any m . If Δ is Cayley it means, in particular, that we can find an affine unimodular transformation of $\mathbb{Z}^d$ such that there is a coordinate where the set of vertices of I_1 has a 0 and the set of vertices I_2 has 1. Now it follows by construction that any word $c \in C_\Delta$ must have $\sum_{i \in I_2} c_i = 0 \pmod{N_\Delta}$ and thus also $\sum_{i \in I_1} c_i = 0 \pmod{N_\Delta}$. Therefore, the corresponding linear code splits into two pieces.

Now suppose that the linear code splits. As we saw above, it implies that the simplex Δ is affine Cayley^{*}. Thus, after an affine unimodular transformation the set of the vertices of Δ splits into two parts I_1 and I_2 . In the first part they have the form $v_i = (0, w_i)$ for $i \in I_1$ and for some $w_i \in \mathbb{Z}^{d-1}$ and in the second part they are of the form $v_i = (k, w_i)$ for $i \in I_2$ and for some $k \in \mathbb{N}$. In other words, there is a projection onto the vertices of the 1-dimensional simplex $[0, k]$.

We are going to show that k must equal 1. Consider two simplices Δ_1 with vertices $(0, w_i)$ for $i \in I_1$ and $(1, w_i)$ for $i \in I_2$ and Δ_k for some $k \geq 2$ with vertices $(0, w_i)$ for $i \in I_1$ and (k, w_i) for $i \in I_2$. Let C_1 and C_k be the corresponding linear codes. Since Δ_1 is Cayley, we know that the corresponding linear code splits. Its words are defined by the rational

numbers $\lambda_i^{(1)}$ such that

$$\sum_{i \in I_1} \lambda_i^{(1)}(0, w_i, 1) + \sum_{i \in I_2} \lambda_i^{(1)}(1, w_i, 1) \in M \oplus \mathbb{Z}.$$

The code C_k is defined by the rational numbers $\lambda_i^{(k)}$ such that

$$\sum_{i \in I_1} \lambda_i^{(k)}(0, w_i, 1) + \sum_{i \in I_2} \lambda_i^{(k)}(k, w_i, 1) \in M \oplus \mathbb{Z}.$$

Note that $N_{\Delta_1} \mid N_{\Delta_k}$. All the tuples $(\lambda_0^{(1)}, \dots, \lambda_d^{(1)})$ also give a tuple for the code C_k , therefore,

$$\frac{N_{\Delta_k}}{N_{\Delta_1}} C_1 \subseteq C_k$$

as sets. Suppose there are tuples $(\lambda_0^{(k)}, \dots, \lambda_d^{(k)})$ not coming from C_1 , then necessarily $\sum_{i \in I_2} \lambda_i^{(k)} \notin \mathbb{Z}$ since otherwise it would correspond to some word of C_1 . This tuple then corresponds to a word that does not satisfy $\sum_{i \in I_2} c_i = 0 \pmod{N_{\Delta_k}}$, i.e. the linear code C_k does not split, a contradiction. Therefore, k must be equal to 1 and the corresponding simplex Δ is Cayley. $\square$

3. FOUR-DIMENSIONAL THIN SIMPLICES

3.1. General strategy of classification. This section is devoted to the proof of the classification of thin four-dimensional simplices presented in Theorem 1. In this subsection we outline the main steps that lead to this result. From the previous section, we know that the search for thin simplices is equivalent to the search of linear codes over $\mathbb{Z}_N$ without maximal weight words or to the search of hyperplane arrangements over $\mathbb{Z}_N$ with empty complement. This way instead of working with d -dimensional simplices we can work simply with the generating matrices of linear codes. Let C be a linear code over $\mathbb{Z}_N$ of length $d + 1$ and let g be an $m \times (d + 1)$ matrix that generates C . We require this code to be extended and require that the greatest common divisor of all the entries of g and N is 1, we write $\gcd(g, N) = 1$. Since the code is extended, the submodule C is in fact a subgroup of $\mathbb{Z}_N^d$, so it is enough to consider $1 \leq m \leq d$.

From now on let us fix the dimension to $d = 4$. From Proposition 1 it follows that if all the $\gcd_i$ satisfy $\gcd_i \leq N/5$, then the linear code C cannot be thin. Since each $\gcd_i$ is a divisor of N , they must be of the form N/α for α an integer. This leads to the following lemma.

Lemma 4. If C is thin, then at least one of the $\gcd_i$ is N/α with $\alpha \in \{2, 3, 4\}$.

For a fixed d Corollaries 3 and 4 suggest that we might have more thin simplices when N is small. To embark upon the classification and simplify the proof we classify the thin linear codes with $N \leq 8$ using a computer algebra. The following proposition is the outcome of a programme written in SageMath available on GitHub².

²<https://github.com/VadymKurylenko/Thin-Simplices>

Proposition 5. For $N \leq 8$ there are 10 non-isomorphic thin linear codes that are not direct sums. Six of them are presented in the Table 1 and the remaining four are members of the family (2).

Building on this classification of thin linear codes with $N \leq 8$, we will gradually cover all the possible remaining cases. We will start with $m = 1$, i.e. generating matrices with one row, and proceed to $m = 4$. It is helpful to note that if the linear code generated by g is thin, then also the linear codes generated by subsets of the rows of g are thin. Moreover, each row of g must contain at least one zero, otherwise we would immediately get a word of maximal weight.

The case when the generating matrix has only one row is quite trivial, since this row must have a zero.

Lemma 5. If $m = 1$ and C is thin, then it corresponds to a lattice pyramid.

For the $m = 2$ case we will proceed as follows. As we noted before, at least one of the columns of g must have $\gcd_i = N/\alpha$ with $\alpha \in \{2, 3, 4\}$. If all the five columns have the same $\gcd_i$, then $\gcd(g, N) \neq 1$. The same happens when four out of the five columns have the same $\gcd_i$ because C is extended. Let

$$M_\alpha := N/\alpha$$

be the maximal $\gcd_i$ of g , then we have to consider the cases when there are 1, 2 or 3 columns with $\gcd_i = M_\alpha$. They are covered in Subsection 3.2 in the Lemmas 6, 7 and 8, respectively. The outcome of these lemmas can be summarized in the following proposition.

Proposition 6. For $m = 2$ and $N \geq 9$ a non-degenerate linear code C that is not a direct sum is thin if and only if N is even and the generating matrix can be chosen as

$$(4) \quad g = \begin{pmatrix} M_2 & M_2 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ M_2 & 0 & M_2 & 1 & N-1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Building on the $m = 2$ case we can deal with the $m = 3$ case using the fact that each pair of the rows of g must generate a thin linear code, thus each such pair is either a multiple of a generating matrix from the $m = 2$ situations or has a column of zeros. In a similar manner we can treat the $m = 4$ case. In Subsections 3.3 and 3.4 we will prove the following.

Proposition 7. Suppose $N \geq 9$, g has three or four rows and it generates a non-degenerate linear code C that is not a direct sum. If C is thin, then it can be generated by a matrix with 2 rows of the form (4), i.e. there are no new interesting linear codes compared to the situation of $m = 2$.

All together, Propositions 5, 6 and 7 combine to Theorem 1 from Introduction.

Note that from now on the equality sign will predominantly mean equality mod N . In the few cases when confusion is possible we will write $=_{\mathbb{Z}}$ for the equality that has to be understood over $\mathbb{Z}$.

3.2. The $m = 2$ case. In this part we are going to treat the generating matrices that have two rows. Recall that for $\alpha = 2, 3, 4$

$$M_\alpha := \frac{N}{\alpha}.$$

Lemma 6. Let $N \geq 9$. Suppose g has two rows and only one column of g has $\gcd_i = M_\alpha$ and other columns have $\gcd_i < M_\alpha$. In this case g does not generate a thin linear code, unless g has a column of zeros.

Proof. No zeros in the column with $\gcd_i = M_\alpha$. Suppose at first that the column with $\gcd_i = M_\alpha$ does not have zeros. Then since every row must have at least one zero, we can write

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} a_1 M_\alpha & b_1 & 0 & b_5 & b_7 \\ a_2 M_\alpha & 0 & b_4 & b_6 & b_8 \end{pmatrix} \\ \begin{matrix} H_0 & H_1 & H_2 & H_3 & H_4 \end{matrix}$$

with $a_i \in \{0, 1, \dots, \alpha-1\}$ such that $\gcd(a_1, a_2, \alpha) = 1$ and $b_i \in \{0, 1, \dots, N-1\}$. The indices H_i of the columns denote the corresponding hyperplanes from $\mathcal{H}_C$ and they are added for the reader's convenience.

Consider a set of points

$$(5) \quad \{(\alpha, 1), (1, \alpha), (\alpha, -1), (-1, \alpha)\} \subseteq \mathbb{Z}_N^2.$$

None of these points can be contained in H_0, H_1 or H_2 , unless $\alpha b_1 = 0$ or $\alpha b_4 = 0$, but this would violate the assumption that only one column has $\gcd_i = M_\alpha$. Thus, these points must be contained in the remaining two hyperplanes. Any triple of the above four points cannot lie in the same hyperplane without violating the assumptions of the lemma. Therefore, H_3 must contain a pair of the points and H_4 must contain the remaining pair.

Suppose that $\alpha \neq 2$, then we might also consider the points

$$\{(\alpha, 2), (2, \alpha)\}.$$

They are not in the hyperplanes H_1 or H_2 . The hyperplane H_0 might contain one of these points if $\alpha = 4$. Suppose that $(\alpha, 2)$ is not in H_0 . One can deduce that among the remaining two hyperplanes it can only be contained in the hyperplane that contains the points $(1, \alpha)$ and $(-1, \alpha)$. Suppose it is H_3 , then we must have $2b_5 = 0$ and $4b_6 = 0$. If $\alpha = 4$, this would mean that $\gcd_3 = M_4$, a contradiction. Thus, we must have $\alpha = 3$ and so $(2, \alpha) \notin H_0$. This point may belong only to the hyperplane that contains $(\alpha, 1)$ and $(\alpha, -1)$, that is H_4 , and this corresponds to $4b_7 = 0$ and $2b_8 = 0$. These restrictions give us

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} a_1 M_3 & b_1 & 0 & N_\Delta/2 & \tilde{b}_7 N_\Delta/4 \\ a_2 M_3 & 0 & b_4 & \tilde{b}_6 N_\Delta/4 & N_\Delta/2 \end{pmatrix}$$

with $\tilde{b}_6, \tilde{b}_7 \in \{1, 3\}$. Consider the points $(1, 1)$ and $(1, -1)$. One can check that now we cannot have both of these points in $\mathcal{H}_C$.

Consider now $\alpha = 2$. Recall that each H_3 and H_4 must contain exactly a pair of points from (5). Suppose $(\alpha, 1), (1, \alpha) \in H_3$, then we must have

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} M_2 & b_1 & 0 & b_5 & b_7 \\ M_2 & 0 & b_4 & b_6 & b_8 \end{pmatrix} \\ \begin{matrix} H_0 & H_1 & H_2 & H_3 & H_4 \end{matrix}$$

with $3b_5 = 3b_6 = 3b_7 = 3b_8 = 0$. Consider the words corresponding to the points $(3, 0)$ and $(0, 3)$. They are $(M_2, 3b_1, 0, 0, 0)$ and $(M_2, 0, 3b_4, 0, 0)$. Since C is extended, we have $3b_1 = M_2$ and $3b_4 = M_2$. Therefore, the hyperplanes H_1 and H_2 do not contain all the points of the form $(3, x)$ and $(x, 3)$ with non-zero x . In particular, the point $(3, 2)$ has to be either in H_3 or in H_4 . It is easy to check that this is not possible in this situation.

If $(\alpha, 1), (-1, \alpha) \in H_3$, the situation is similar. Now the corresponding conditions are $5b_5 = 5b_6 = 5b_7 = 5b_8 = 0$. It gives $5b_1 = M_2$ and $5b_4 = M_2$. This again does not allow H_1 or H_2 to contain the point $(3, 2)$. One can check that it also does not belong to H_3 or H_4 .

If $(\alpha, 1), (\alpha, -1) \in H_3$, then we have $4b_5 = 4b_8 = 0$ and $2b_6 = 2b_7 = 0$. It gives $4b_1 = M_2$ and $4b_4 = M_2$. Therefore, the point $(3, 2)$ must be contained again in H_3 or H_4 . This is not possible unless, for example, $b_5 = 0$ and $2b_6 = 0$, but this would give $\gcd_3 = M_2$.

A zero in the column with $\gcd_i = M_\alpha$. Suppose the column with $\gcd_i = M_\alpha$ has a zero entry. Note that the points $(1, 1)$ and $(1, -1)$ must be in $\mathcal{H}_C$, thus, the generating matrix must be of the form

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} a_1 M_\alpha & 0 & b_3 & b_5 & b_7 \\ 0 & b_2 & -b_3 & b_5 & b_8 \end{pmatrix}.$$

$H_0 \quad H_1 \quad H_2 \quad H_3 \quad H_4$

Let us consider the following table, where the entries are the values (up to sign) on the corresponding points taken by the linear forms defining the hyperplanes H_2 and H_3 . None of the points from the table can be contained

	$(1, \alpha)$	$(-1, \alpha)$	$(\alpha + 1, 1)$	$(\alpha + 1, 2)$	$(\alpha + 1, -1)$	$(\alpha + 1, -2)$
H_2	$(\alpha - 1)b_3$	$(\alpha + 1)b_3$	αb_3	$(\alpha - 1)b_3$	$(\alpha + 2)b_3$	$(\alpha + 3)b_3$
H_3	$(\alpha + 1)b_5$	$(\alpha - 1)b_5$	$(\alpha + 2)b_5$	$(\alpha + 3)b_5$	αb_5	$(\alpha - 1)b_5$

in H_0 or H_1 .

Consider the pair of points $(\alpha + 1, 1)$ and $(\alpha + 1, 2)$. None of them can be contained in H_2 , since both of the conditions $\alpha b_3 = 0$ and $(\alpha - 1)b_3 = 0$ would imply $\gcd_i \geq M_\alpha$. Moreover, they cannot be both in H_3 , since it would require $b_5 = 0$. Thus, at least one of them must be in H_4 . The same logic applies to the pair of points $(\alpha + 1, -1)$ and $(\alpha + 1, -2)$.

Suppose one of the points $(\alpha + 1, 1)$ and $(\alpha + 1, 2)$ belongs to H_3 , then the point $(1, \alpha)$ must be in H_4 since otherwise either $b_5 = 0$ or $2b_5 = 0$. On the contrary, if both of the points $(\alpha + 1, 1)$ and $(\alpha + 1, 2)$ belong to H_4 , then $(1, \alpha) \notin H_4$, since it would require $b_7 = b_8 = 0$. Again, the same applies for the pair $(\alpha + 1, -1), (\alpha + 1, -2)$ and the point $(-1, \alpha)$.

Therefore, one of the following options must be satisfied:

- $(\alpha + 1, 1), (\alpha + 1, -1), (1, \alpha), (-1, \alpha) \in H_4$,
- $(\alpha + 1, 1), (\alpha + 1, -2), (1, \alpha), (-1, \alpha) \in H_4$,
- $(\alpha + 1, 2), (\alpha + 1, -1), (1, \alpha), (-1, \alpha) \in H_4$,
- $(\alpha + 1, 2), (\alpha + 1, -2), (1, \alpha), (-1, \alpha) \in H_4$,
- $(\alpha + 1, 1), (\alpha + 1, 2), (\alpha + 1, -1), (\alpha + 1, -2) \in H_4$.

It is a quick check that in the first four cases one obtains $2b_7 = 2b_8 = 0$ and hence $\gcd_4 = N/2$, a contradiction. The last case requires $b_8 = (\alpha + 1)b_7 = 0$. Moreover, in this case both of the points $(1, \alpha)$ and $(-1, \alpha)$

must be in $H_2 \cup H_3$, that is $(\alpha + 1)b_3 = (\alpha + 1)b_5 = 0$. Consider the first row of g and multiply it with $(\alpha + 1)$, since C is extended we have $a_1M_\alpha + (\alpha + 1)(b_3 + b_5 + b_7) = a_1M_\alpha = 0$, i.e. the first column is a zero column, so the code is degenerate. $\square$

Lemma 7. Let $N \geq 9$. Suppose g has two rows and exactly two columns have $\gcd_i = M_\alpha$ and the other columns have $\gcd_i < M_\alpha$. In this situation g cannot generate a thin non-degenerate linear code.

Proof. No zeros in the columns with $\gcd_i = M_\alpha$. Suppose first that the columns with $\gcd_i = M_\alpha$ don't have any zeros, then

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} a_1M_\alpha & a_3M_\alpha & 0 & b_3 & b_5 \\ a_2M_\alpha & a_4M_\alpha & b_2 & 0 & b_6 \end{pmatrix}.$$

$H_0 \qquad H_1 \qquad H_2 \quad H_3 \quad H_4$

As in the previous lemma consider the points

$$\{(\alpha, 1), (1, \alpha), (\alpha, -1), (-1, \alpha)\}.$$

Under the assumptions none of these points can be contained in the first four hyperplanes. They cannot all be contained in H_4 as well. Therefore, the complement of $\mathcal{H}_C$ is not empty.

A zero in one of the columns with $\gcd_i = M_\alpha$. Suppose that one of the columns with $\gcd_i = M_\alpha$ has a zero, hence we can write

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} a_1M_\alpha & 0 & b_1 & b_3 & b_5 \\ a_2M_\alpha & a_4M_\alpha & 0 & b_4 & b_6 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Suppose the points $(1, 1)$ and $(1, -1)$ do not belong to H_0 , then we must have

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} a_1M_\alpha & 0 & b_1 & b_3 & b_5 \\ a_2M_\alpha & a_4M_\alpha & 0 & -b_3 & b_5 \end{pmatrix}.$$

$H_0 \qquad H_1 \qquad H_2 \quad H_3 \quad H_4$

Consider the points $(\alpha, 1)$ and $(\alpha, \alpha + 1)$. They cannot be in H_3 since it would correspond to $(\alpha - 1)b_3 = 0$ (violates that $\gcd_3 < M_\alpha$) or $b_3 = 0$ (gives a column of zeros). Therefore, both of them must be in H_4 , but this would give $\alpha b_5 = 0$, that is, $\gcd_4 = M_\alpha$.

Suppose now that the point $(1, 1)$ is not in H_0 , but $(1, -1)$ is. Note that in this case the hyperplane containing $(1, 1)$ cannot contain any of $(\alpha, 1)$ and $(\alpha, \alpha + 1)$. Therefore, both of these points must lie in the remaining hyperplane H_4 , so we can write

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} a_1M_\alpha & 0 & b_1 & b_3 & b_5 \\ a_1M_\alpha & a_4M_\alpha & 0 & -b_3 & -\alpha b_5 \end{pmatrix}$$

with $\alpha^2 b_5 = 0$. Consider the word corresponding to the point $(0, \alpha)$

$$(0, 0, 0, -\alpha b_3, 0).$$

Since the linear code must be extended, it is necessary to have $\alpha b_3 = 0$ and $\gcd_3 = M_\alpha$.

Suppose that the point $(1, -1)$ is not in H_0 , but $(1, 1)$ is. The hyperplane containing $(1, -1)$ cannot contain $(\alpha, -1)$, otherwise it would have $\gcd_i >$

M_α . Therefore, we can write

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} a_1 M_\alpha & 0 & b_1 & b_3 & b_5 \\ -a_1 M_\alpha & a_4 M_\alpha & 0 & b_3 & \alpha b_5 \end{pmatrix}.$$

$H_0 \quad H_1 \quad H_2 \quad H_3 \quad H_4$

Since $(1, 1) \in H_0$, $(1, -1) \notin H_0$ and the zeroth column has no zero entries, we must have $\alpha \neq 2$. So we can consider the point $(2, -1)$. Clearly, it is not contained in the first 4 hyperplanes, and the last one can contain it only if $(\alpha - 2)b_5 = 0$. If $\alpha = 3$, then $b_5 = 0$, and the last column is a column of zeros. If $\alpha = 4$, then $2b_5 = 0$ and the last column is $(b_5, 0)^t$, but then $\gcd_4 = M_2$.

We have deduced that both $(1, 1)$ and $(1, -1)$ must belong to H_0 . This is possible only if $\alpha = 2$ and $a_1 = a_2 = 1$. Using the fact that C is extended we have

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} M_2 & 0 & b_1 & b_3 & M_2 - b_1 - b_3 \\ M_2 & M_2 & 0 & b_4 & -b_4 \end{pmatrix}.$$

$H_0 \quad H_1 \quad H_2 \quad H_3 \quad H_4$

Consider the points $(\alpha, 1)$ and $(2\alpha, 1)$. If both belonged to H_3 we would have $\alpha b_3 = 0$ and $b_4 = 0$, that is, $\gcd_3 = M_2$. The same is true for the pair of points $(\alpha, -1)$ and $(2\alpha, -1)$. We have to distribute the points in these pairs between H_3 and H_4 . It is enough to consider only two cases out of four.

Suppose $(\alpha, 1)$ and $(2\alpha, -1)$ belong to H_3 . The other two points must be in H_4 . It gives

$$\alpha b_3 + b_4 = 2\alpha b_3 - b_4 = -\alpha(b_1 + b_3) + b_4 = -2\alpha(b_1 + b_3) - b_4 = 0.$$

From this we deduce that $3b_4 = 0$ and $3\alpha b_3 = 3\alpha b_1 = 0$. Under this conditions none of H_3 and H_4 can contain the point $(\alpha, \alpha + 1)$ unless $\alpha b_4 = 0$. Since $\alpha = 2$, this is equivalent to $2b_4 = 0$, which together with $3b_4 = 0$ gives $b_4 = 0$. Then, in turn, together with $\alpha b_3 + b_4 = 0$ implies $2b_3 = 0$, that is $\gcd_3 = M_2$.

Now suppose $(\alpha, 1)$ and $(\alpha, -1)$ belong to H_3 . It gives

$$\alpha b_3 + b_4 = \alpha b_3 - b_4 = -2\alpha(b_1 + b_3) - b_4 = -2\alpha(b_1 + b_3) + b_4 = 0.$$

It follows that $2b_4 = 0$. We cannot have $b_4 = 0$ since it would give $\gcd_3 = M_\alpha$, therefore we need $\alpha = 2$ and $b_4 = M_2$. Moreover, we must have $2\alpha b_3 = 4b_3 = 0$ and $4\alpha b_1 = 8b_1 = 0$. Therefore, we can write

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} M_2 & 0 & \tilde{b}_1 N/8 & \tilde{b}_3 N/4 & M_2 - \tilde{b}_1 N/8 - \tilde{b}_3 N/4 \\ M_2 & M_2 & 0 & M_2 & M_2 \end{pmatrix}.$$

for $\tilde{b}_1 \in \{1, 2, \dots, 7\}$ and $\tilde{b}_3 \in \{1, 3\}$. We see that $N/8 \mid g$ and we can reduce to the existing classification of linear codes with $N \leq 8$.

zeros in the columns with $\gcd_i = M_\alpha$. Suppose that both columns with $\gcd_i = M_\alpha$ have a zero. Suppose at first that these zeros are in the different rows. Since the first two hyperplanes do not contain $(1, 1)$ and $(1, -1)$ we can write

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} a_1 M_\alpha & 0 & b_1 & b_3 & b_5 \\ 0 & a_4 M_\alpha & -b_1 & b_3 & b_6 \end{pmatrix}.$$

$H_0 \quad H_1 \quad H_2 \quad H_3 \quad H_4$

Assume that $\alpha \neq 2$. Consider the points $(2, 1)$, $(1, 2)$, $(2, -1)$, $(-1, 2)$. One can check that none of them can belong to the first four hyperplanes under the given assumptions, thus, they must be in H_4 , but this is possible only if it is a zero column.

Now consider $\alpha = 2$. Since the code is extended, $b_5 = M_2 - b_1 - b_3$ and $b_6 = M_2 + b_1 - b_3$. Consider the following table that contains points and the values (up to a sign) achieved on these points by the linear functionals defining H_2, H_3 and H_4 .

	$(3, 1)$	$(3, -1)$	$(1, 3)$	$(1, -3)$	$(5, 1)$	$(5, -1)$
H_2	$2b_1$	$4b_1$	$2b_1$	$4b_1$	$4b_1$	$6b_1$
H_3	$4b_3$	$2b_3$	$4b_3$	$2b_3$	$6b_3$	$4b_3$
H_4	$2b_1 + 4b_3$	$4b_1 + 2b_3$	$2b_1 - 4b_3$	$4b_1 - 2b_3$	$4b_1 + 6b_3$	$6b_1 + 4b_3$

All of the above points will be in the hyperplane arrangement if $4b_1 = 4b_3 = 0$, but this would imply $N/4 \mid g$. If both $4b_1 \neq 0$ and $4b_3 \neq 0$ then some of these points are not in $\mathcal{H}_C$. Therefore, exactly one of $4b_1$ and $4b_3$ must be zero. We can choose $4b_1 = 0$ and $4b_3 \neq 0$. The other case clearly gives an equivalent linear code. Now the point $(3, 1)$ must belong to H_4 , i.e. we must have $2b_1 + 4b_3 = 0$, which implies $8b_3 = 0$. Thus, $N/8 \mid g$ and we again reduced to the existing classification of codes with $N \leq 8$.

Now suppose that both of the zeros from the columns with $\gcd_i = M_\alpha$ are in the same row, so we have

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} a_1 M_\alpha & a_3 M_\alpha & b_1 & b_3 & b_5 \\ 0 & 0 & -b_1 & b_3 & b_6 \end{pmatrix}.$$

In the same way as in the previous case we deduce that we need $\alpha = 2$, thus

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} M_2 & M_2 & b_1 & b_3 & -b_1 - b_3 \\ 0 & 0 & -b_1 & b_3 & b_1 - b_3 \end{pmatrix}.$$

The last table remains unchanged for this situation, thus we reduce again to the situation $N \leq 8$. $\square$

Lemma 8. Let $N \geq 9$. Suppose g has two rows and exactly three columns have $\gcd_i = M_\alpha$ and the other columns have $\gcd_i < M_\alpha$. In this case for even N there exists a thin linear code that is not a direct sum and it is generated by

$$(6) \quad g = \begin{pmatrix} M_2 & M_2 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ M_2 & 0 & M_2 & 1 & N-1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Note that these linear codes correspond to simplices of width 1 due to Proposition 4.

Proof. No zeros in the columns with $\gcd_i = M_\alpha$. Suppose that the columns with $\gcd_i = M_\alpha$ don't have any zeros, then

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} a_1 M_\alpha & a_3 M_\alpha & a_5 M_\alpha & 0 & b_3 \\ a_2 M_\alpha & a_4 M_\alpha & a_6 M_\alpha & b_2 & 0 \end{pmatrix}.$$

In this case $M_\alpha \mid g$ since the linear code is extended.

At least one zero in the columns with $\gcd_i = M_\alpha$ but only in one row. Consider

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} a_1 M_\alpha & a_3 M_\alpha & a_5 M_\alpha & 0 & b_3 \\ a_2 M_\alpha & a_4 M_\alpha & 0 & b_2 & b_4 \end{pmatrix}$$

$H_0 \quad H_1 \quad H_2 \quad H_3 \quad H_4$

with possibly a_2 and a_4 being zero and other a_i being nonzero. Since the linear code is extended, b_3 is divisible by M_α . Consider the points $(1, \alpha)$ and $(-1, \alpha)$. They cannot be contained in the first four hyperplanes, therefore, both of them belong to H_4 . This leads to $2\alpha b_4 = 0$ and $2b_3 = 0$, forcing $\alpha \neq 3$ since $M_\alpha \mid b_3$. If $\alpha = 2$, then $N/4$ divides g . So we need to consider only $\alpha = 4$.

Consider the points $(2, 1)$ and $(3, 1)$. Since $2b_3 = 0$ none of these points can be in H_4 unless it is a column of zeros or $\gcd_4 = N/2$. Thus, they must belong to the hyperplanes H_0 and H_1 . Clearly, they cannot be in the same one of these hyperplanes. We can assume that $(2, 1) \in H_0$ and $(3, 1) \in H_1$. This implies that the generating matrix g is divisible by $N/8$ so we can reduce to the case $N = 8$.

Two columns with $\gcd_i = M_\alpha$ have zeros in different rows. Consider

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} a_1 M_\alpha & 0 & a_5 M_\alpha & b_1 & b_3 \\ a_2 M_\alpha & a_4 M_\alpha & 0 & b_2 & b_4 \end{pmatrix}$$

$H_0 \quad H_1 \quad H_2 \quad H_3 \quad H_4$

with possibly one of a_1 or a_2 being zero. Suppose at first that $\alpha \neq 2$. The points $(1, 1)$ and $(1, -1)$ cannot belong to the same hyperplane unless its $\gcd_i = M_2$, therefore, we have to distribute them among two different hyperplanes. Suppose that $(1, 1) \in H_3$ and $(1, -1) \in H_4$. This implies that the points $(2, 1)$, $(2, -1)$, $(1, 2)$ and $(1, -2)$ do not belong to neither of these hyperplanes, unless one of them is a zero column or they have $\gcd_3 = \gcd_4 = M_3$. Thus, all these points must belong to H_0 , but it is possible only if it is a zero column.

Another option is to have $(1, 1) \in H_0$ and $(1, -1) \in H_3$ (the situation of $(1, -1) \in H_0$ and $(1, 1) \in H_3$ is equivalent). We have

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} a_1 M_\alpha & 0 & a_5 M_\alpha & b_1 & b_3 \\ -a_1 M_\alpha & a_4 M_\alpha & 0 & b_1 & b_4 \end{pmatrix}$$

$H_0 \quad H_1 \quad H_2 \quad H_3 \quad H_4$

The points $(2, 1)$ and $(1, 2)$ cannot belong to H_0 and also they do not belong to H_3 since it would imply $\gcd_3 = M_3$. The only possibility left is $(2, 1), (1, 2) \in H_4$, but this implies $\gcd_4 = M_3$ as well.

Consider now $\alpha = 2$. The generating matrix takes form

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} a_1 M_2 & 0 & M_2 & b_1 & (-a_1 + 1)M_2 - b_1 \\ M_2 & M_2 & 0 & b_2 & -b_2 \end{pmatrix}$$

$H_0 \quad H_1 \quad H_2 \quad H_3 \quad H_4$

Suppose $a_1 = 0$. Then without loss of generality $(1, 1)$ must be in H_3 . The point $(3, 1)$ then must be in H_4 , which would imply $4b_1 = 0$ and $N/4 \mid g$.

So we have to consider only the case when $a_1 = 1$ and

$$(7) \quad g = \begin{pmatrix} M_2 & 0 & M_2 & b_1 & -b_1 \\ M_2 & M_2 & 0 & b_2 & -b_2 \end{pmatrix}$$

It is easy to see that for any choice of b_1 and b_2 these linear codes are thin. The proof is concluded by the following lemma

Lemma 9. For any non-zero choice of (b_1, b_2) the linear code C generated by (7) is either a direct sum or it is isomorphic to the code generated by

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} M_2 & M_2 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ M_2 & 0 & M_2 & 1 & N-1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

The corresponding simplex has

$$h^*(\Delta_C, t) = \left(\frac{3N}{2} - 1 \right) t^2 + \frac{N}{2} t + 1.$$

Proof. Let us describe all the words in the linear code generated by (7). First, let us show that all the words of the form

$$(0, 0, 0, 2k, -2k)$$

for $k \in \{0, 1, \dots, N/2 - 1\}$ appear in C . For this it is enough to show that there are coefficients (c_1, c_2) that give the word $(0, 0, 0, 2, N-2)$. If $\gcd(b_1, b_2, M_2) \neq 1$, then it divides g and we reduce to the same type of situation but for a lower N . Therefore, we can assume that $\gcd(b_1, b_2, M_2) = 1$. By Bezout's identity there exist integers x, y, z such that $xb_1 + yb_2 + zM_2 =_{\mathbb{Z}} 1$ consequently $2xb_1 + 2yb_2 + zN =_{\mathbb{Z}} 2$. Considering this identity modulo N we see that we can take $(c_1, c_2) = (2x, 2y) \pmod{N}$. Note that there are no words of the form $(0, 0, 0, k, -k)$ for odd k .

Suppose, b_1 and b_2 are odd. Since $\gcd(b_1, b_2, N) = 1$ there are integers x, y, z such that

$$xb_1 + yb_2 + zN =_{\mathbb{Z}} 1.$$

Since N is even and b_1, b_2 are odd, exactly one of x and y must be even. Considering this identity modulo N we deduce that there are such coefficients (c_1, c_2) that give us words $(M_2, M_2, 0, 1, -1)$ and $(M_2, 0, M_2, 1, -1)$. Multiplying these with odd numbers we get all the words of the form

$$(M_2, M_2, 0, 2k+1, -2k-1) \quad \text{and} \quad (M_2, 0, M_2, 2k+1, -2k-1).$$

We are left to consider the coefficients (c_1, c_2) with both c_i odd. Take $(c_1, c_2) = (b_2, -b_1)$. This gives us the word $(0, M_2, M_2, 0, 0)$. Adding to this word all the words of the form $(0, 0, 0, 2k, -2k)$ from before we can get all the words of the form

$$(0, M_2, M_2, 2k, -2k).$$

This way we exhausted all the possible coefficients (c_1, c_2) .

Now suppose that b_1 is odd and b_2 is even. The same considerations as above allow one to deduce that the corresponding linear code C contains all the words of the form $(0, M_2, M_2, 2k+1, -1-2k)$, $(M_2, M_2, 0, 2k+1, -1-2k)$, $(M_2, 0, M_2, 2k, -2k)$. So C is not exactly the same as the codes with odd b_1 and b_2 but a permutation of the first three columns gives an isomorphism between them.

Finally, suppose that both b_1 and b_2 are even. This is possible only if $4 \nmid N$ since otherwise we would have $2 \mid g$. Since $4 \nmid N$, we have odd M_2 . Consider the word $(M_2, M_2, 0, b_1, -b_1)$ and multiply it with M_2 . Since b_1 is even, it gives $(M_2, M_2, 0, 0, 0)$. In a similar way we obtain $(M_2, 0, M_2, 0, 0)$ from $(M_2, 0, M_2, b_2, -b_2)$. We also have $(0, M_2, M_2, 0, 0)$ as their sum. Now

adding the words $(0, 0, 0, 2k, -2k)$ to these, we obtain all the possible words in C . Having the list of all the words in C , we see that in the case of b_1 and b_2 being even the linear code can be generated by the matrix

$$\begin{pmatrix} M_2 & M_2 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ M_2 & 0 & M_2 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 2 & -2 \end{pmatrix}$$

as well. Thus, this is a direct sum and the corresponding simplex is a free join.

Since for different choices of b_1 and b_2 the codes are isomorphic, we can simply fix $(b_1, b_2) = (0, 1)$ and arrive so at the statement of the lemma. It is easy to compute the corresponding h^* -polynomials, since the words correspond to the integral points of the half-open parallelepiped. $\square$

$\square$

With this lemma we have covered all the possible cases of g with two rows. Now we can move on to the generating matrices with three rows.

3.3. $m = 3$ cases.

Proposition 7 (Part 1). Suppose $N \geq 9$, g has three rows and it generates a non-degenerate linear code C that is not a direct sum. If C is thin, then it can be generated by a matrix with 2 rows of the form (4).

Proof. If a matrix g with three rows generates a thin linear code, then matrices constructed from the pairs of rows of g must also generate thin linear codes. We can choose the first two rows to be a multiple of a generating matrix of a thin code and add a third row to it. For the first two rows we have six options: a matrix with a column of zeros, multiples of the cases 2,3,4,6 from Table 1 and multiples of the matrices from Lemma 9. We have to treat them one by one.

Case 2 from Table 1. We look at the generating matrices over $\mathbb{Z}_{3k}$ for $k \geq 3$ of the form

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 & k & k & k \\ k & 2k & 0 & k & 2k \\ a_0 & a_1 & a_2 & a_3 & a_4 \end{pmatrix}$$

such that $\gcd(g) = 1$. If we want the first and the third rows to generate a thin code, then we need $a_0 = 0$ ($a_1 = 0$ is equivalent). Same argument applied to the second and third row gives $a_2 = 0$. We reduced to

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 & k & k & k \\ k & 2k & 0 & k & 2k \\ 0 & a_1 & 0 & a_3 & -a_1 - a_3 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Consider the points $(1, 1, 1)$ and $(1, 2, 1)$. One can check that they cannot be both in $\mathcal{H}_C$ unless $k \mid g$.

Cases 3,4 and 6 from Table 1. All these cases behave quite similarly in this situation. We present here only the case 3. We look at the generating matrices over $\mathbb{Z}_{4k}$ for $k \geq 3$ of the form

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 & k & k & 2k \\ 2k & 2k & k & 3k & 0 \\ a_0 & a_1 & a_2 & a_3 & a_4 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Since the first and the third row must generate a thin code, we need $a_0 = 0$ ($a_1 = 0$ is equivalent). The second and the third row generate a thin code under one of the following conditions:

- (1) $a_4 = 0$,
- (2) $a_1 = 2k, a_4 = 2k$.

In the first scenario we have

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 & k & k & 2k \\ 2k & 2k & k & 3k & 0 \\ 0 & a_1 & a_2 & -a_1 - a_2 & 0 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Consider again the points $(1, 1, 1)$ and $(1, 2, 1)$. One can check, that we cannot cover both of them unless $k \mid g$.

In the second scenario we have

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 & k & k & 2k \\ 2k & 2k & k & 3k & 0 \\ 0 & 2k & a_2 & -a_2 & 2k \end{pmatrix}.$$

The point $(1, 1, 2)$ can be in $\mathcal{H}_C$ if either $a_2 = 0$ or $2a_2 = 2k$, but both of these conditions lead to $k \mid g$.

First two rows given by a generating matrix belonging to the family (2). Let N be even. Consider generating matrices over $\mathbb{Z}_N$ of the form

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} M_2 & M_2 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ M_2 & 0 & M_2 & 1 & -1 \\ a_0 & a_1 & a_2 & a_3 & a_4 \end{pmatrix}.$$

One can show that if we considered instead the first two rows of g multiplied by an integer $k \geq 2$, then similar to the already treated situations we would arrive at $k \mid g$. Therefore, it is enough to consider the matrix above.

First of all, we need that the the first and the third rows

$$\begin{pmatrix} M_2 & M_2 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ a_0 & a_1 & a_2 & a_3 & a_4 \end{pmatrix}$$

generate a thin linear code. It is possible if any of the following conditions is true:

- (1) $a_2 = 0$,
- (2) $a_3 = 0$,
- (3) $a_2 = M_2, a_0 = M_2, a_1 = 0$,
- (4) $a_2 = M_2, a_0 = 0, a_1 = M_2$.

We also need the same for the second and third rows

$$\begin{pmatrix} M_2 & 0 & M_2 & 1 & -1 \\ a_0 & a_1 & a_2 & a_3 & a_4 \end{pmatrix}.$$

It is possible if

- (5) $a_1 = 0$,
- (6) $a_1 = M_2, a_0 = M_2, a_2 = 0$,
- (7) $a_2 = M_2, a_0 = 0, a_1 = M_2$ (note, this is the same as condition (4)).

There are the following consistent pairs of the above conditions that do not trivially give a linear code equivalent to the one generated by the first two rows: (1) and (5), (1) and (6), (2) and (5), (3) and (5), (4) and (7).

Let us consider the above pairs one by one.

Conditions (1) and (5). In this case we have

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} M_2 & M_2 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ M_2 & 0 & M_2 & 1 & -1 \\ a_0 & 0 & 0 & a_3 & a_4 \\ H_0 & H_1 & H_2 & H_3 & H_4 \end{pmatrix}.$$

If $(1, 1, 1) \in H_0$, then $a_0 = 0$ and $a_4 = -a_3$. If a_3 is even, the the third row is a linear combination of the first two as we have seen in Lemma 9. If a_3 is odd, then we can show that the resulting linear code is equivalent to the one generated by

$$(8) \quad g = \begin{pmatrix} M & M & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ M & 0 & M & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & -1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

See Lemma 10 below.

If $(1, 1, 1) \notin H_0$, then up to a permutation of the last two columns it must lie in H_3 . We have

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} M_2 & M_2 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ M_2 & 0 & M_2 & 1 & -1 \\ a_0 & 0 & 0 & -1 & 1 - a_0 \\ H_0 & H_1 & H_2 & H_3 & H_4 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Consider the point $(1, 1, -1)$. It cannot be in the hyperplane arrangement unless $a_0 = 0$ (which leads to the situation of Lemma 10) or $a_0 = 2$ in which case the point $(1, 1, 2)$ is neither in H_0 nor in H_4 as long as $N \geq 9$.

Lemma 10. The linear code over $\mathbb{Z}_N$ generated by

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} M_2 & M_2 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ M_2 & 0 & M_2 & 1 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & a & -a \end{pmatrix}$$

with odd a is isomorphic to the code generated by

$$g_0 = \begin{pmatrix} M_2 & M_2 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ M_2 & 0 & M_2 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & -1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

This is a direct sum, in particular, the corresponding simplex is a free join of $2\Delta_2$ and a 1-dimensional interval of length N .

Proof. Since a is odd, the following equalities hold

$$\begin{aligned} (M_2, 0, M_2, 0, 0) &= a (M_2, 0, M_2, 1, -1) - (0, 0, 0, a, -a), \\ (0, 0, 0, 1, -1) &= (1 - a) (M_2, 0, M_2, 1, -1) + (0, 0, 0, a, -a) \end{aligned}$$

This is an invertible linear transformation between the last two rows of g and g_0 . Therefore, the linear codes generated by g and g_0 are isomorphic. $\square$

Conditions (1) and (6). In this case the generating matrix is

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} M_2 & M_2 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ M_2 & 0 & M_2 & 1 & -1 \\ M_2 & M_2 & 0 & a_3 & -a_3 \end{pmatrix}.$$

We can substitute the third row by the difference of the third and the first rows. Now again it is either the linear code generated by the first two rows if a_3 is even or it is the situation of the Lemma 10 if a_3 is odd.

Conditions (2) and (5). In this case the generating matrix is

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} M_2 & M_2 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ M_2 & 0 & M_2 & 1 & -1 \\ a_0 & 0 & a_2 & 0 & -a_2 - a_0 \end{pmatrix}.$$

$H_0 \quad H_1 \quad H_2 \quad H_3 \quad H_4$

Consider the words corresponding to the points $(1, 2, 1)$ and $(1, 2, -1)$. They are

$$(a_0 + M_2, M_2, a_2, 2, -2 - a_2 - a_0), \quad (-a_0 + M_2, M_2, -a_2, 2, -2 + a_2 + a_0).$$

There are exactly three options how both of them can have a zero. The first one is $a_2 = 0$, i.e.

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} M_2 & M_2 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ M_2 & 0 & M_2 & 1 & -1 \\ a_0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & -a_0 \end{pmatrix}.$$

The point $(1, 1, 1)$ can be contained only in H_4 , i.e. $a_0 = -1$. Consider now the word corresponding to the point $(1, 1, 2)$. It is $(-2, M_2, M_2, 1, 1)$, so the code generated by g cannot be thin.

The second option is to have $a_2 = -a_0 - 2 = -a_0 + 2$. This implies $4 = 0$, so necessarily $N = 4$.

The only option left is to have $a_0 = M_2$, which gives

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} M_2 & M_2 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ M_2 & 0 & M_2 & 1 & -1 \\ M_2 & 0 & a_2 & 0 & M_2 - a_2 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Consider the points $(1, 1, 1)$ and $(1, 1, -1)$. They correspond to the words

$$(M_2, M_2, M_2 + a_2, 1, M_2 - 1 - a_2), \quad (M_2, M_2, M_2 - a_2, 1, M_2 - 1 + a_2).$$

There are two ways for both of these words to have a zero. It is possible if $a_2 = M_2 - 1 = M_2 + 1$, but it implies $2 = 0$, that is $N = 2$. The other option is $a_2 = M_2$. Now we can substitute the second row with the difference of the second and the third rows and we see that this linear code is a direct sum and the corresponding simplex is a free join of $2\Delta_2$ and the interval of length N .

Conditions (3) and (5). In this case the generating matrix is

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} M_2 & M_2 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ M_2 & 0 & M_2 & 1 & -1 \\ M_2 & 0 & M_2 & a_3 & -a_3 \end{pmatrix}.$$

If a_3 is odd, then the last row is already a word in the linear code generated by the first two rows, so we need to consider only even a_3 . In this case from the last two rows we can get the words

$$\begin{aligned} (M, 0, M, 0, 0) &= a_3 (M, 0, M, 1, -1) - (M, 0, M, a_3, -a_3), \\ (0, 0, 0, 1, -1) &= (a_3 + 1) (M, 0, M, 1, -1) - (M, 0, M, a_3, -a_3). \end{aligned}$$

This is an invertible transformation, so the generating matrix

$$\begin{pmatrix} M_2 & M_2 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ M_2 & 0 & M_2 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & -1 \end{pmatrix}$$

generates the same linear code.

Conditions (4) and (7). In this case the generating matrix is

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} M_2 & M_2 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ M_2 & 0 & M_2 & 1 & -1 \\ 0 & M_2 & M_2 & a_3 & -a_3 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Again we have either a direct sum or the third row is a combination of the first two. The proof is almost identical to the previous case.

A column of zeros in every pair of rows So far we have showed that if any pair of the rows of a generating matrix with three rows is non-degenerate, then there are no new interesting linear codes comparing to the case of just two rows. The only option left to consider is when all the restrictions from three rows to two rows have a column of zeros. In this case the generating matrix takes the form

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} d_1 & 0 & 0 & b_1 & b_4 \\ 0 & d_2 & 0 & b_2 & b_5 \\ 0 & 0 & d_3 & b_3 & b_6 \end{pmatrix}.$$

$H_0 \quad H_1 \quad H_2 \quad H_3 \quad H_4$

We will show that this matrix cannot generate a thin linear code for $N \geq 9$ unless this code is a direct sum.

Consider the points $(1, 1, 1)$, $(1, 1, -1)$, $(1, -1, 1)$, $(-1, 1, 1)$. They must be contained in the union $H_3 \cup H_4$. One can check that if one of these hyperplanes contains three out of the four points, then it necessarily contains the fourth one as well. Thus, up to permuting these hyperplanes there are two possible situations: either H_3 contains two out of four points or all of them.

Let us start with the case when all the four points are in H_3 . It requires $2b_1 = 2b_2 = 2b_3 = 0$ and $b_1 + b_2 + b_3 = 0$. We can choose $b_1 = b_2 = M_2$ and $b_3 = 0$. Now we have

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} d_1 & 0 & 0 & M_2 & M_2 - d_1 \\ 0 & d_2 & 0 & M_2 & M_2 - d_2 \\ 0 & 0 & d_3 & 0 & -d_3 \end{pmatrix}.$$

$H_0 \quad H_1 \quad H_2 \quad H_3 \quad H_4$

Consider the points of the form $(2, \pm 1, \pm 1)$. They can be either in H_0 or H_4 . If $2d_1 \neq 0$, then all of them must be in H_4 . In that case $2d_1 = 2d_2 = 4d_1 = 0$, which implies $N/4 \mid g$. Therefore, we must have $2d_1 = 0$. By considering the points $(\pm 1, 2, \pm 1)$ we arrive in the same way at $2d_2 = 0$. Now we have

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} M_2 & 0 & 0 & M_2 & 0 \\ 0 & M_2 & 0 & M_2 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & d_3 & 0 & -d_3 \end{pmatrix},$$

which is a direct sum.

Now consider the situation when each of H_3 and H_4 contain only two out of the four points. Say, $(1, 1, 1)$, $(1, 1, -1)$ are in H_3 and $(1, -1, 1)$, $(-1, 1, 1)$ are in H_4 . It implies the generating matrix must be of the form

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} d_1 & 0 & 0 & b_1 & b_4 \\ 0 & d_2 & 0 & \tilde{b}_3 M_2 - b_1 & \tilde{b}_6 M_2 + b_4 \\ 0 & 0 & d_3 & \tilde{b}_3 M_2 & \tilde{b}_6 M_2 \end{pmatrix}$$

with $\tilde{b}_i = 0$ or 1 . We cannot have $\tilde{b}_3 = \tilde{b}_6$ since it would imply $d_3 = 0$. It is enough to consider $\tilde{b}_3 = 0$ and $\tilde{b}_6 = 1$, which gives $d_3 = M_2$. Since the code is extended we can write

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} d_1 & 0 & 0 & b_1 & -d_1 - b_1 \\ 0 & M_2 + d_1 + 2b_1 & 0 & -b_1 & M_2 - d_1 - b_1 \\ 0 & 0 & M_2 & 0 & M_2 \end{pmatrix}$$

H_0
 H_1
 H_2
 H_3
 H_4

Consider the point $(2, 1, 1)$. If it is in H_0 , then $d_1 = M_2$. In this case, the point $(1, 2, 1)$ cannot belong to H_1 since it would give $4b_1 = 0$ and $N/4 \mid g$, so this point must belong to H_4 giving $3b_1 = 0$. Consider now the point $(3, 2, 1)$. The only option is $(3, 2, 1) \in H_4$, but now this would imply $b_1 = 0$ giving a few columns of zeros.

Suppose now that $(2, 1, 1) \in H_4$, i.e. $-3(d_1 + b_1) = 0$. Consider the point $(1, 2, 1)$. If it belongs to H_1 , then $2d_1 + 4b_1 = 0$, implying $b_1 = d_1$ and $N/6 \mid g$. The other option is to have $(1, 2, 1) \in H_4$, which leads to $M_2 - 3(d_1 + b_1) = M_2 = 0$, a contradiction.

Now we have considered all the possible generating matrices of interest with three rows. $\square$

3.4. $m = 4$ case.

Proposition 7 (Part 2). Suppose $N \geq 9$, g has four rows and it generates a non-degenerate linear code C that is not a direct sum. If C is thin, then it can be generated by a matrix with 2 rows of the form (4).

Proof. Each pair and triple of the rows of g should generate a thin linear code, therefore we have the following three options for the first three rows

- multiples of the case 5 from Table 1,
- a direct sum with a factor $C_{2\Delta_2}$,
- three rows with a column of zeros.

From the proof of Proposition 7 it follows that the direct sum case can only lead to a thin code that is again a direct sum.

Consider the situation when the first three rows is a multiple of the generating matrix of the case 5 from Table 1. We have

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 & k & k & 2k \\ 2k & 2k & 0 & 2k & 2k \\ 0 & 2k & 3k & 3k & 3k \\ a_0 & a_1 & a_2 & a_3 & a_4 \end{pmatrix}$$

over $\mathbb{Z}_{4k}$ with $k \geq 3$. From the previous subsection we know that if g has three rows and $N \geq 9$, then either it is a member of the family (2) or it is a direct sum with a factor $C_{2\Delta_2}$. In both of these cases there should be

three columns with $\gcd_i = M_2$. We see that that if consider the last three rows of g , it is not possible to choose a_i 's in such a way, that there are three columns with $\gcd_i = M_2$. Therefore, the linear code generated by g cannot be thin.

The only option left now is when each triple of rows of g has a column of zeros, i.e.

$$g = \begin{pmatrix} d_1 & 0 & 0 & 0 & -d_1 \\ 0 & d_2 & 0 & 0 & -d_2 \\ 0 & 0 & d_3 & 0 & -d_3 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & d_4 & -d_4 \end{pmatrix}.$$

The fourth hyperplane must contain all the points $(\pm 1, \pm 1, \pm 1, \pm 1)$. This leads to all $d_i = M_2$, i.e. g is just a multiple of the Case 1 from Table 1. $\square$

This finishes the classification of the four-dimensional thin simplices.

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